Owning your AI agent systems.

Own the setup. Skills, tools, data, and the ask before anything goes out.

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Owning used to sound like running the server. For a law firm it now means owning the four parts a client would recognize as yours. Rent the model. Rent the computer. Keep the practice.

Skills

The playbooks. How the firm does one job, written so an agent can follow it, including the stop.

Tools

Which systems you choose to connect, and which stay closed until a person has watched a pilot.

Data

What information may leave the firm, where it goes, and what the vendor does with it.

Approvals

The rule for sending, filing, paying, or deleting, and the person who says yes.

About twenty-five minutes in the room, then questions. The live demo uses fictional matters only. No client information is in this packet.

Three places an agent can live.

Built into the legal software. A good start.

Filevine's Lois works inside Filevine. It can read a matter and write work back to the system of record. Clio's Vincent works inside Clio Work: research and drafts, and, with a matter selected, actions in Clio Manage. Both vendors still expect a lawyer to review the output. If the job already lives in that system, start there. Ryan McKean favors buying this ready-made. That is the right advice when the work never needs to leave the matter.

A commercial agent. Spend the time here.

Claude, ChatGPT, and Grok Bot. You connect tools, write procedures, and supervise. Someone else runs the computers. This is the practical default when a job crosses more than one system. The rest of this guide stays on Grok Bot, because its design choices are the ones to look for in any of them.

Hermes. Powerful, and built for a particular user.

> Hermes works really well. It is an extremely powerful desktop agent, and some of what it can do is more useful than what the commercial apps allow. It is built for software engineers and for people who like the nitty-gritty. By default it runs on your own computer. You can give it a cloud computer, and then you manage that computer. ChatGPT, Claude, and Grok Bot come with a computer and take care of that. You also design the system: memory, web search, telemetry, and the rest. Those services exist. You piece them together. Vendor agents ship them already joined.
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> I kept my own branch of the code because the desktop app's design didn't fit how I work. Every update meant resolving conflicts with the main branch. For most lawyers, other workarounds exist, and that headache is a poor trade against a system you can buy. Data sovereignty, security, a worry that prices will be run up, and a wish for open-source models are fair reasons to take it on. You pay with a rougher experience, a harder setup, and the maintenance.

A map, not a score. What drew me to Grok Bot is how little there is to set up: click Connect, point it at a skills repo if you have one, tell it the job, and give each role a bot.

Easy to set up. Worth looking at closely.

Checked against public docs in October 2026. If a control has moved, the current docs win.

Connect. Open Connect apps, choose Add, and sign in with the provider. The token stays off the computer. The bot calls the tool and does not receive the login. A connected app is available to every bot on your account. A teammate's Team Bot asks before it uses your accounts.

Skills. A skill is the procedure: when to use it, the steps, how to check, and what needs a person. Type / to call one. One library is shared across your bots. Turn a skill on for the bot that should have it. Save it after the task works once.

Routines. Say the schedule in a sentence to the bot that should own it. Confirm the owner, the clock and time zone, the source, the result, the approval line, and what happens when the source is missing. A test run does real work. Routines can run with the laptop closed.

Computer. Each bot works on a cloud computer with a browser, files, and a terminal, and you can watch the screen. On one account it is a single computer. Each bot has its own screen. Files and signed-in sessions are shared. A second bot is not a wall around a client's file. Between users, the computers are isolated.

Vault and 1Password. The bot can sign in without seeing the password or the one-time code. 1Password fills a login you approve and does not open the rest of the vault. A saved card can be used at checkout without a fresh approval. Leave a firm card out if you want a yes on every charge.

Draft, then ask. Have it prepare the message and stop. The card shows the action. Allow once, always allow, or deny. Auto Review checks tool calls and computer actions before they run. An ask-first rule beats an allow rule. Automatic review is a backstop. The lawyer still reviews the work.

Pages. Ask for a report, tracker, or dashboard beside the chat. A routine can refresh it. On a self-serve plan a shared page can be public. Keep client information off it.

A roster. Give each stable job its own bot. Mine includes Research, Ops, Finance, Marketing, Leads, Mailroom, Home, and others. That list is an operating choice, not a template. Use a group chat when the handoff should be visible.

Phone calls, and private-network reach such as Tailscale, are coming. They are not part of this setup.

The duties do not move to the vendor.

Confidentiality. Rule 1.6.

Before a real matter is connected, know where the information goes, who can see it, whether it is used to train a model, and how long it is kept. Grok Bot stores data and does not offer Legacy Privacy Mode. Training choices follow the account's privacy settings. Inside one account, every bot can see the shared computer's files and sign-ins.

Supervision and competence. Rules 5.3 and 1.1.

You check the output. Competence includes understanding the tool you supervise. A bot is not a member of the bar. ABA Formal Opinion 512 (2024) is the longer discussion. Missouri numbers the same duties 4-1.6, 4-5.3, and 4-1.1. Confirm the text in your own jurisdiction.

The yes.

Send, file, pay, and delete wait for a person. Put that in the skill and in an ask-first rule. A sentence in a prompt is not the control. Set the rule before a real inbox is connected. An approval does not undo work already done.

A copy you can move.

Keep the playbook in your own files, in plain language. The demo folder has a sample skill. Test it on the next platform before you need to switch. The open Agent Skills format is one way to structure the file. Storage inside a product is not an export guarantee.

Vendor risk.

Read retention, subprocessors, and what happens to connected apps if the account closes. Re-read the docs when a workflow starts touching client information. Treat phone calls and Tailscale as coming.

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One useful job: read the task, read what arrived, draft only the missing piece,
stop if authority is unclear, send nothing.
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Ethics citations are discussion prompts for firm owners, not an opinion on a particular stack.

FIELD GUIDE 05 / FIRST-WEEK WORKSHEET

Four moves, then look.

1. One tool

Which product this week? Lois or Vincent if the job lives in that system. A commercial agent if it crosses systems.

2. Two apps

Which two will you connect? What stays disconnected until someone has reviewed the pilot?

3. One skill

Name the process. Write the steps, the stop, and the action that waits for a person.

4. One routine

When does it run, and in which time zone? What does a normal run return? What stays unsent? What happens when the source is missing?

5. Reviewer

Who checks the output before anything goes out?

6. Portable copy

Where will the skill live outside the product?

7. Sample, then data

Which fictional or nonconfidential example comes first? What do the current terms say about storage, retention, and training?

Read the current page.

Grok Bot overview
docs.x.ai/grok-bot/overview

Computer, screens, and Connect apps
docs.x.ai/grok-bot/computer-and-apps

Skills and routines
docs.x.ai/grok-bot/skills-routines-and-automations

Approvals, Auto Review, shared computer
docs.x.ai/grok-bot/approvals-security-and-privacy

Files and Pages · Bots
docs.x.ai/grok-bot/files-and-results · docs.x.ai/grok-bot/bots

Vault · 1Password
cursor.com/help/grok-bot/secrets · 1password.com/partners/spacexsi-grokbot

Filevine Lois · Clio Vincent
filevine.com/news/filevine-launches-lois-console · help.clio.com · Understand Clio Work

Claude · ChatGPT · Hermes · Agent Skills
claude.com/solutions/enterprise · help.openai.com · connected apps · hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs · agentskills.io

ABA Model Rules 1.6, 1.1, 5.3 · Formal Opinion 512
Rule 1.6 · Rule 1.1 · Rule 5.3 · Formal Opinion 512

Vendor pages describe products. They are not a security certification. The demo runbook and fictional sample matters are in the demo folder of the site. Keep this PDF if the hosted site is later removed.

Claims checked October 2026. Features and terms change. All sample matters are fictional.